

“Q-comm will become much bigger”

Amazon India's Samir Kumar on how technology can be used to ease challenges hindering the scaling of quick commerce in India

BY PALAK AGARWAL



AMAZON'S QUICK-COMMERCE push has made the global e-commerce giant a late entrant to a market where Blinkit has already established a clear lead, while Zepto and Instamart have emerged as prominent players. Its core e-commerce rival, Flipkart Minutes, also entered the segment earlier.

Amazon's decision to enter the fray and seize a share of the market is a bold move as it continues to scale its presence in Indian e-commerce. In a conversation with *Business Today*, Samir Kumar, Vice President and Country Manager, India, Amazon, discusses the company's ambitions and strategy—not just to enter India's increasingly competitive quick-commerce market, but to emerge as one of its winners. Edited excerpts:

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Amazon has been in India for over a decade. As quick commerce moves beyond 10-minute delivery, what will define its next phase?

Quick commerce and e-commerce together are going to be a big part of the overall Indian market in the coming years. E-commerce penetration is still at a very nascent stage, so we have a lot to do because customers value price, selection, and convenience.

Small buildings can only carry so much inventory. So, whoever can manage the supply chain well eventually is going to be one of the contenders.

Our game is never about convenience. It is about the value and selection we offer. We already offer the largest selection to Indian consumers across every

speed point. We offer close to 4.5 million items that can be delivered in a day. You can take a subset of that and deliver it in hours. Minutes, hours, and days help us win on price, selection and convenience.

Our selection across home, kitchen, and softlines such as apparel and shoes will also be important, along with serving the everyday needs of customers.

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Amazon has a strong one-day delivery network and is expanding quick commerce. Can you use your supply-chain advantage to offer a wider assortment through faster delivery and deepen your presence beyond metros?

For us to deliver in 10, 15 or even 30 minutes or an hour, that assortment

has to be located close to the customer. But not every inventory item moves as fast. The challenge is placing the right inventory in the right locations, and carrying the largest assortment at the smallest possible depth in a sustainable way. That is where the technology and tools we have developed over the years will come into play.

We started with 10,000-15,000 SKUs or ASINs, as we call them at Amazon, but we are rapidly expanding that because we have 4.5 million items sitting in our warehouses. We know, based on customer frequency and where customers live, what the demand is in each area.

We are setting up our first set of dark stores, or micro-fulfilment centres, focused on everyday essentials. In every city where we operate, we are

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